

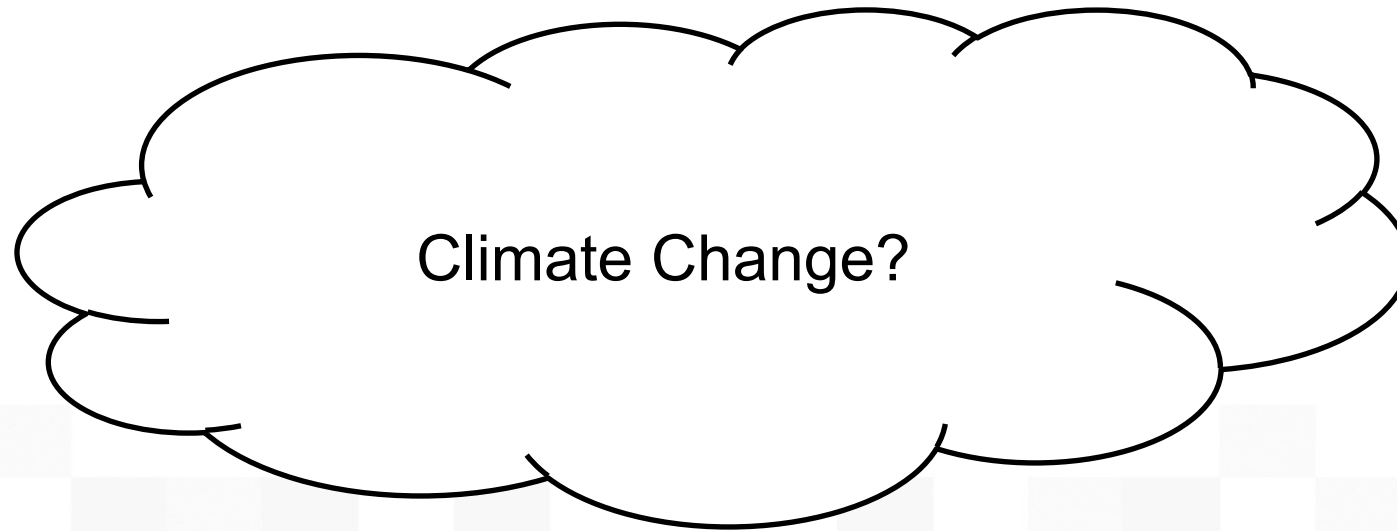
Topic Input

Climate Change



THE LONDON SCHOOL
OF ECONOMICS AND
POLITICAL SCIENCE ■

What words come to mind when you think of
“climate change”?



Discussion questions



1. What is climate change? What are some of the causes and consequences? Have you noticed any changes in the climate in your home country?
2. Who should be most responsible for taking action on climate change: governments, companies, or individuals? Why?
3. What can be done to reduce the impacts of climate change? What technological, political, or societal barriers might stand in the way?
4. In your view, is climate change primarily a scientific issue, a political issue, or a moral issue? How should that framing influence our response?

Listening 1



You are going to hear (see!) a short talk about climate change and the future of humanity by David Wallace-Wells on RSA Minimate.

First, **watch without sound** and predict the content.

Then, **listen with sound**. Were your predictions correct?

Answer the questions on the next slide.

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Minimate

Questions



1. The speaker says, “*Every aspect of our lives will be touched by climate change.*” Why does he say this? Do you agree?
2. According to the speaker, “*More than half of all the fossil fuel emissions that we have put into the atmosphere in all of human history have been produced in the last 25 years*”. Why is that significant?
3. If we do not change course, what could the situation be like by the end of the century in terms of: agriculture, economics, conflict and natural disasters?
4. What are some of the adjectives the speaker uses at the end? Is his overall view optimistic or pessimistic? Do you share his view?

Use of language



In the talk, the speaker uses the term 'climate change' but some people feel we should use stronger language.

Climate Change

'Climate catastrophe' and not 'Climate change'

What do you think? Does the language we use impact how we feel?
Compare the terms on the next slide.

How do the terms below differ in terms of impact?

1. Climate change vs. climate crisis, climate catastrophe or climate emergency
 2. Climate denier vs. climate sceptic
 3. Carbon emissions vs. greenhouse gas emissions
 4. Global warming vs. global heating
 5. Biodiversity vs. wildlife
 6. Fish stocks vs. fish populations
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Table 1. Word changes *The Guardian* recommended to its journalists and editors (Source: [Zeldin-O'Neill, 2019](#)).

Previous expressions	Recommended expressions
“Climate change”	“Climate emergency”, “climate crisis”
“Climate sceptic”	“Climate science denier”, “climate denier”
“Global warming”	“Global heating”
“Carbon emissions”, “carbon dioxide emissions”	“Greenhouse gas emissions”
“Biodiversity”	“Wildlife”
“Fish stocks”	“Fish populations”

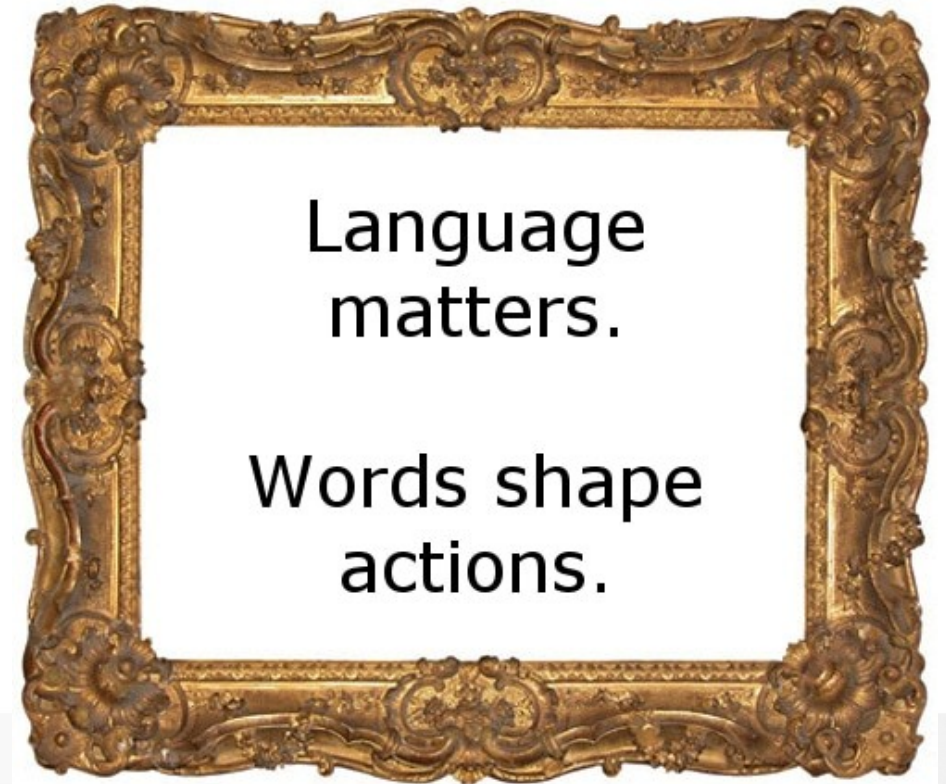


Framing in communication

On Moodle, there is an article about how the way we use language can influence public perception and engagement. The report discusses four ways of 'framing' language:

- A. Gain vs. Loss Frames
- B. Individual vs. Collective Action Frames
- C. Present vs. Future Frames
- D. Local vs. Global Frames

Read about one of the above and then report back to your group (each person in the group should read about a different framing strategy).



Without looking at the article, complete the summary below:



1. Gain vs. Loss Frames: Research shows that _____ frames are more effective for promoting climate change mitigation efforts, _____ frames are more impactful for adaptation strategies.
2. Individual vs. Collective Action Frames: These frames focus on whether environmental responsibility is portrayed as personal or societal. Both have their strengths and limitations, with effectiveness often depending on the specific context and audience.
3. Present vs. Future Frames: The temporal framing of environmental issues can significantly impact engagement. _____ frames can create urgency and emotional engagement, while _____ frames can inspire long-term thinking and transformative changes.
4. Local vs. Global Frames: The geographical scale at which environmental issues are presented can affect public response. _____ frames can make issues personally relevant, while _____ frames can convey the scale and complexity of environmental challenges.

Without looking at the article, complete the summary below:



1. Gain vs. Loss Frames: Research shows that **gain** frames are more effective for promoting climate change mitigation efforts, while **loss** frames are more impactful for adaptation strategies.
2. Individual vs. Collective Action Frames: These frames focus on whether environmental responsibility is portrayed as personal or societal. Both have their strengths and limitations, with effectiveness often depending on the specific context and audience.
3. Present vs. Future Frames: The temporal framing of environmental issues can significantly impact engagement. **Present** frames can create urgency and emotional engagement, while **future** frames can inspire long-term thinking and transformative changes.
4. Local vs. Global Frames: The geographical scale at which environmental issues are presented can affect public response. **Local** frames can make issues personally relevant, while **global** frames can convey the scale and complexity of environmental challenges.